

LEVEL OF USABILITY OF A WEB-BASED CONSULTATION SYSTEM AMONG COLLEGE STUDENTS AND FACULTY MEMBERS

A Research Paper Presented to the Faculty of ABC College
In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for Practical Research

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APPROVAL SHEET

This research paper entitled LEVEL OF USABILITY OF A WEB-BASED CONSULTATION SYSTEM AMONG COLLEGE STUDENTS AND FACULTY MEMBERS prepared by Juan D. Santos, Maria L. Reyes, Carlo P. Cruz has been examined and recommended for acceptance and approval.

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ABSTRACT

This quantitative study determined the level of usability of a web-based consultation system among students and faculty members of ABC College. The study used a descriptive quantitative research design. A validated questionnaire was administered to one hundred forty (140) respondents. Data were analyzed using frequency, percentage, weighted mean, standard deviation, and t-test. Results showed that the system obtained a grand mean of 4.44, interpreted as Strongly Agree. The study recommends improving notifications, adding calendar integration, and conducting wider testing.

Keywords: consultation, academic support, usability, student experience, research

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

Introduction

Academic consultation is a necessary support service because it allows students to ask questions, clarify requirements, and receive guidance from faculty members. In many educational institutions, consultation schedules are still arranged through walk-in visits, informal messages, or verbal agreements.

Digital scheduling systems provide a possible way to organize this process. A web-based consultation system can make professor availability visible, allow students to submit booking requests, send status updates, and maintain consultation records.

Background of the Study

The problem addressed in this study is the lack of an organized and transparent consultation scheduling process. When consultation requests are scattered across messages, students may not know whether a professor is available, while faculty members may find it difficult to monitor pending requests, confirmed appointments, cancellations, and completed sessions.

Similar appointment-scheduling research emphasizes that digital scheduling can improve access, coordination, and user convenience when systems are designed around user needs (Ala & Chen, 2022; Betancor et al., 2025).

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the level of usability of a web-based consultation system among college students and faculty members. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

- What is the profile of the respondents in terms of user role and year level?
- What is the level of usability of the web-based consultation system in terms of efficiency, effectiveness, learnability, and satisfaction?
- Is there a significant difference in the usability assessment when respondents are grouped according to user role?
- What improvements may be proposed based on the findings?

Objectives of the Study

The general objective of this study is to determine the level of usability of the web-based consultation system. Specifically, it aims to identify the profile of respondents, determine the level of usability, test whether there is a significant difference by user role, and

propose improvements based on the results.

Hypothesis

H0: There is no significant difference in the usability assessment of the web-based consultation system when respondents are grouped according to user role.

Significance of the Study

This study is significant to students, faculty members, administrators, and future researchers. Students may benefit from clearer consultation support. Faculty members may benefit from improved schedule monitoring. Administrators may use the findings as basis for improving academic support services. Future researchers may use this study as a reference.

Scope and Delimitations

This study focuses on academic consultation in a college setting during academic year 2026. It covers consultation scheduling, student-faculty interaction, and user experience related to the consultation process. It does not include enrollment systems, grading systems, payment systems, or long-term academic performance outcomes.

Limitations of the Study

The study may be limited by the number of available respondents or participants, the honesty of responses, and the specific setting where the study is conducted.

Definition of Terms

Term	Definition in the Study
Academic Consultation	A scheduled or requested interaction between a student and faculty member for academic purposes.
Consultation System	A platform or process used to manage consultation requests, schedules, and records.
Usability	The degree to which a system is easy, efficient, learnable, and satisfactory to use.
Student Experience	The thoughts, feelings, challenges, and actions of students during consultation requests.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND STUDIES

Introduction

This chapter presents literature, studies, theory, framework, synthesis, and research gap related to academic consultation, appointment scheduling, usability, and student support.

Related Literature

Academic consultation is part of student support because it allows learners to receive feedback and guidance from faculty members. In technology-supported environments, appointment systems can reduce uncertainty by making schedules visible and by providing clear status updates.

Usability is important when evaluating a digital system. A system may contain useful features, but if users find it confusing, slow, or difficult to navigate, the system may not be adopted successfully.

Related Studies

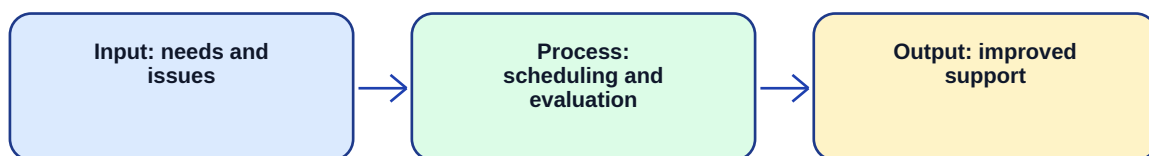
Studies on electronic appointment systems show that online scheduling can improve user access, reduce waiting uncertainty, and support better coordination between users and service providers (Ala & Chen, 2022; Betancor et al., 2025).

Theoretical Framework

The Technology Acceptance Model supports system-related research because it explains that perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use influence user acceptance. For qualitative student-support research, social support theory may guide interpretation.

Conceptual Framework

Figure 2.1 Conceptual Framework



The framework shows that consultation problems and user needs serve as input. The process includes scheduling, communication, data gathering, and evaluation. The output is an improved understanding or improved system.

Synthesis

The reviewed literature and studies show that academic consultation is an important support process and that digital appointment systems can improve access and organization. However, there remains a need for studies that focus specifically on student-faculty consultation in a local academic setting.

Research Gap

The gap addressed by this study is the limited focus on academic consultation management in local college settings. This study contributes by focusing on consultation usability and student experience.

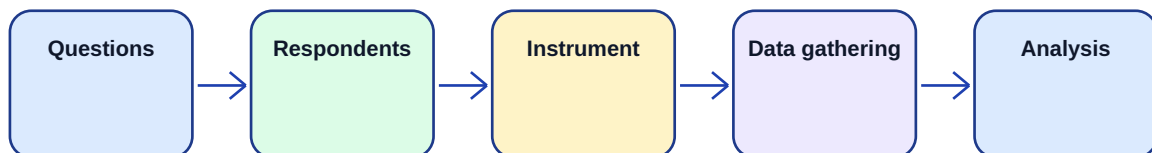
CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Research Design

This study uses a descriptive quantitative research design because it aims to determine the level of usability of the system and compare assessment results between user groups.

Figure 3.1 Methodology Flow



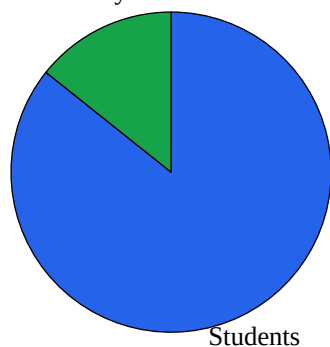
Research Locale

The study will be conducted at ABC College, an academic institution where students regularly seek consultation from faculty members.

Respondents / Participants

The respondents will be one hundred forty (140) system users composed of one hundred twenty (120) students and twenty (20) faculty members.

Figure 3.2 Respondent Distribution



Sampling Technique

Purposive sampling will be used because the study requires individuals who have direct experience with the topic.

Research Instrument

The research instrument will be a researcher-made questionnaire. Part I will gather the respondent profile, while Part II will assess usability using a five-point Likert scale.

Scale	Verbal Interpretation
5	Strongly Agree
4	Agree
3	Neutral
2	Disagree
1	Strongly Disagree

Validation of Instrument

The instrument will be reviewed by research and subject-matter experts. Validators will check clarity, relevance, organization, and alignment with the research questions.

Data Gathering Procedure

Figure 3.3 Data Gathering Procedure



The researchers will first request permission from the school. After approval, respondents or participants will be informed about the purpose of the study. Data will then be gathered using the appropriate instrument.

Ethical Considerations

Participation will be voluntary. Respondents and participants will be informed about the purpose of the study, their right to withdraw, and the confidentiality of their responses.

Data Analysis

Research Question	Data Needed	Statistical Tool
Profile	User role and year level	Frequency and percentage
Usability level	Likert ratings	Weighted mean and SD
Difference by role	Grouped mean scores	t-test
Improvements	Lowest indicators and comments	Descriptive interpretation

CHAPTER 4

PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS, AND INTERPRETATION OF DATA

Introduction

This chapter presents the results of the study based on the order of the research questions. Each table, graph, or theme is followed by analysis and interpretation.

Profile of Respondents

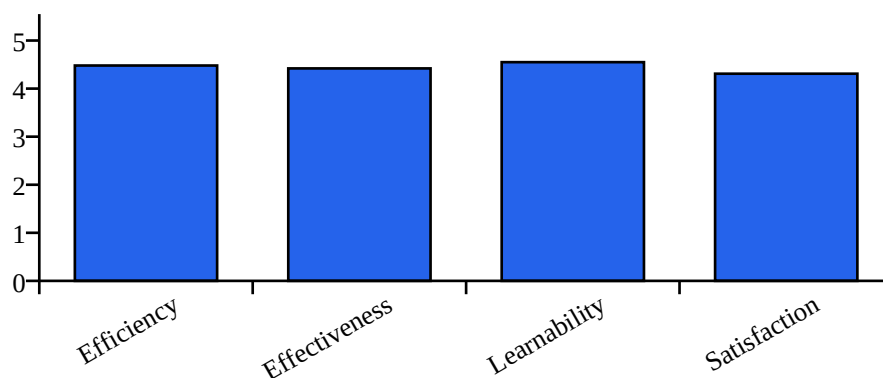
User Role	Frequency	Percentage
Students	120	85.71%
Faculty Members	20	14.29%
Total	140	100%

The table shows that most respondents were students, the main users who request consultation appointments.

Usability Assessment

Indicator	Mean	SD	Interpretation	Rank
Efficiency	4.48	0.51	Strongly Agree	2
Effectiveness	4.42	0.56	Strongly Agree	3
Learnability	4.55	0.47	Strongly Agree	1
Satisfaction	4.31	0.62	Strongly Agree	4
Grand Mean	4.44	0.54	Strongly Agree	

Figure 4.1 Usability Mean Scores



The system obtained a grand mean of 4.44, interpreted as Strongly Agree. Learnability ranked highest, showing that users found the system easy to understand. Satisfaction ranked lowest but still received a positive interpretation.

Significant Difference

Group	Mean	t-value	p-value	Decision
Students	4.43	0.62	0.536	Not Significant
Faculty Members	4.47			

The p-value of 0.536 is greater than 0.05. Therefore, the null hypothesis is not rejected.

Discussion of Findings

The findings support the idea that academic consultation can be improved through clearer communication and structured scheduling. High usability ratings or clear qualitative themes show that students and faculty members need an organized consultation process.

CHAPTER 5

SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Summary of the Study

This study determined the level of usability of a web-based consultation system among students and faculty members. It used a descriptive quantitative design and statistical analysis.

Summary of Findings

- The majority of respondents were students.
- The system obtained a grand mean of 4.44, interpreted as Strongly Agree.
- There was no significant difference in assessment between students and faculty members.

Conclusions

The web-based consultation system is highly usable and acceptable to users. It can support academic consultation by improving schedule visibility, booking organization, and consultation monitoring.

Recommendations

- Schools may adopt clearer consultation scheduling procedures.
- Faculty members may provide visible consultation availability and timely confirmation.
- Developers may improve notification features, mobile responsiveness, and calendar integration.
- Future researchers may conduct wider studies using larger samples, mixed methods, or different academic settings.

Action Plan

Objective	Activity	Responsible	Timeframe	Expected Output
Improve scheduling clarity	Using official booking channel	School / Faculty	1 month	Clearer consultation process
Improve notifications	Add real-time alerts	Developers	1 month	Better status visibility
Expand evaluation	Conduct wider testing	Researchers	2 months	More reliable findings

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APPENDICES

Appendix A. Letter of Permission

A formal permission letter may be attached here to show that the researchers requested approval before conducting data gathering.

Appendix B. Research Instrument

Indicator	Sample Item
Efficiency	The system allows users to complete consultation booking quickly.
Effectiveness	The system helps users accomplish consultation-related tasks.
Learnability	The system is easy to understand even for first-time users.
Satisfaction	The user is satisfied with the overall consultation system.

Appendix C. Validation Form

This appendix may include expert validation ratings and comments for the research instrument.

Appendix D. Sample Computation or Coding Matrix

For quantitative research, attach sample weighted mean computation. For qualitative research, attach a coding matrix showing codes, categories, and themes.

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